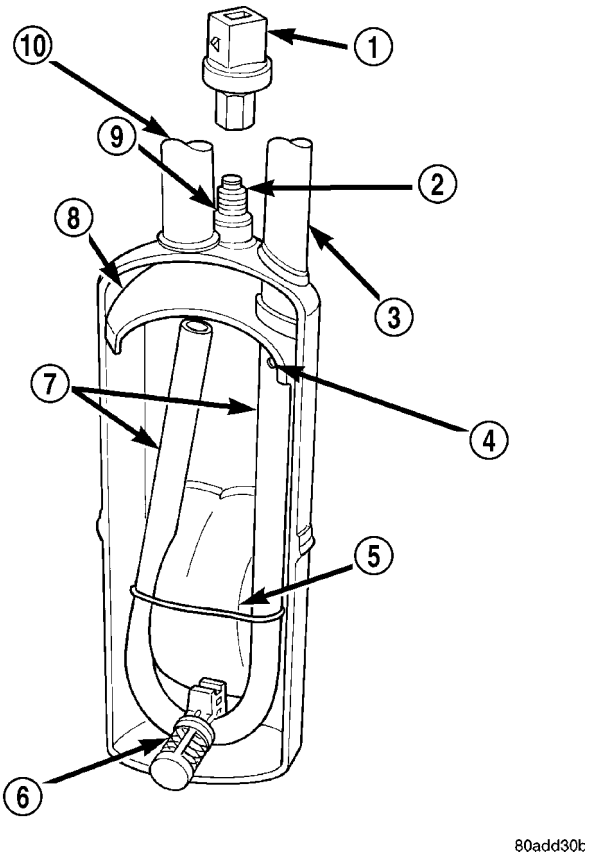

Fig. 14 Accumulator - Typical

1 - A/C LOW PRESSURE SWITCH
2 - PRESSURE SWITCH FITTING
3 - OUTLET TO COMPRESSOR
4 - ANTI-SIPHON HOLE
5 - DESICCANT BAG
6 - OIL RETURN ORIFICE FILTER
7 - VAPOR RETURN TUBE
8 - ACCUMULATOR DOME
9 - O-RING SEAL
10 - INLET FROM EVAPORATOR

OPERATION

Refrigerant enters the A/C accumulator mostly as a low pressure vapor through the inlet tube. Any liquid, oil-laden refrigerant falls to the bottom of the canister, which acts as a separator. A desiccant bag is mounted inside the accumulator canister to absorb any moisture which may have entered and become trapped within the refrigerant system A filter is also mounted inside the canister to trap any foreign material that may have entered the refrigerant system during assembly. The low pressure vapor exits the A/C accumulator through the outlet tube.

The A/C accumulator cannot be repaired. If the A/C accumulator is faulty or damaged, or if an internal failure of the A/C compressor has occurred, the A/C accumulator must be replaced.

REMOVAL

WARNING: Refer to the applicable warnings and cautions for this system before performing the following operation (Refer to 24 - HEATING & AIR CONDITIONING/PLUMBING - WARNINGS) and (Refer to 24 - HEATING & AIR CONDITIONING/PLUMBING - CAUTIONS). Failure to follow the warnings and cautions could result in possible personal injury or death.

(1) Disconnect and isolate the negative battery cable.

(2) Recover the refrigerant from the refrigerant system (Refer to 24 - HEATING & AIR CONDITIONING/PLUMBING - STANDARD PROCEDURE - REFRIGERANT SYSTEM RECOVERY).

(3) Disconnect the wire harness connector from the A/C low pressure switch.

(4) If required, remove the A/C low pressure switch from the accumulator and remove and discard the O-ring seal.

(5) Remove the plastic retaining clip that secures the suction line to the liquid line near the accumulator.

(6) Loosen the bolt that secures the accumulator retaining band to the support bracket located on the dash panel.

(7) Remove the nuts that secure the refrigerant lines to the accumulator (Fig. 15).

(8) Disconnect the refrigerant lines from the accumulator and remove and discard the O-ring seals.

(9) Install plugs in, or tape over the opened refrigerant line fittings and accumulator ports.

(10) Pull the accumulator and retaining band forward until the bolt in the band is clear of the slotted hole in the support bracket.

(11) Remove the accumulator from the engine compartment and if necessary, remove the retaining band from the accumulator.